

NYAYA-VAISESIKA (NYĀYA–VAIŚEṢIKA)

REALIST SYSTEM MAP → SIXTEEN NYĀYA TOPICS VERSUS SEVEN CATEGORIES (PADĀRTHAS) → FOUR MEANS OF VALID → INFERENCE ENGINE → CAUSATION AND ATOMISM

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g15 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

REALIST SYSTEM MAP

REALIST SYSTEM MAP

VALID KNOWLEDGE AND ARGUMENT VAIŚEṢIKA

INVENTORY OF REALITY

NYĀYA–VAIŚEṢIKA REALISM + PLURALISM + LIBERATION THROUGH TRUTH VALID

OBJECTS CORRECTLY KNOWN

FALSE NOTIONS REMOVED

FAULTS CEASE KARMA-PRODUCING ACTION CEASES

REBIRTH AND PAIN CEASE

NYĀYA: valid knowledge and argument VAIŚEṢIKA: inventory of reality

NYĀYA–VAIŚEṢIKA realism + pluralism + liberation through truth valid cognition (pramā) → objects correctly known

notions removed → faults cease karma-producing action ceases → rebirth and pain cease → RELEASE

Nyāya: 4 means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- NYĀYA: valid knowledge and argument VAIŚEṢIKA: inventory of reality
- NYĀYA–VAIŚEṢIKA realism + pluralism + liberation through truth valid cognition (pramā) → objects correctly known → false

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- notions removed → faults cease karma-producing action ceases → rebirth and pain cease → RELEASE (apavarga).
- Nyāya: 4 means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- classical Vaiśeṣika: perception + inference historically two allied systems; later synthesis, not identity from the start
- NYĀYA: valid knowledge and argument VAIŚEṢIKA: inventory of reality

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 4 means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) | classical Vaiśeṣika: perception + inference historically two allied systems; later synthesis, not identity from the start.

01

STAGE 01

SIXTEEN NYĀYA TOPICS VERSUS SEVEN VAIŚEṢIKA CATEGORIES

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NYĀYA 16

TOPICS OF INQUIRY, PROOF AND DEBATE MEANS OF VALID

ESTABLISHED CONCLUSION (SIDDHĀNTA) AVAYAVA

HYPOTHETICAL REASONING (TARKA)

VITANḌĀ HETVĀBHĀSA

PRAMEYA 12

VAIŚEṢIKA 7

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

NYĀYA 16 = topics of inquiry, proof and debate means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)
established conclusion (siddhānta) avayava
hypothetical reasoning (tarka)
vitanḍā hetvābhāsa

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

PRAMEYA 12: self → body/senses/objects → cognition/mind → activity/defects
rebirth/fruit/suffering → release
VAIŚEṢIKA 7 = kinds of being: substance (dravya)
quality (guṇa)

EVALUATION / TRAP

motion or action (karma) viśeṣa
inherence (samavāya)
absence (abhāva)
DO NOT FLATTEN: Nyāya inquiry map != Vaiśeṣika ontology

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NYĀYA 16 = topics of inquiry, proof and debate means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) | prameya | samśaya | prayojana | dṛṣṭānta | established conclusion (siddhānta) avayava | hypothetical reasoning (tarka) | nirṇaya | vāda | jalpa | vitanḍā hetvābhāsa | chala | jāti | nigrahasthāna.

02

STAGE 02

SEVEN CATEGORIES (PADĀRTHAS)

SEVEN CATEGORIES (PADĀRTHAS)

CATEGORY (PADĀRTHA)

WHATEVER IS NAMEABLE AND KNOWABLE

1 DRAVYA

EARTH, WATER, FIRE, AIR, ĀKĀŚA, TIME, SPACE, SELF, MIND

2 QUALITY (GUṆA)

QUALITY; DEPENDS ON SUBSTANCE, DOES NOT ITSELF POSSESS QUALITY/ACTION

3 ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (KARMA)

CATEGORY (padārtha): whatever is nameable and knowable

1 DRAVYA: earth, water, fire, air, ākāśa, time, space, self, mind

2 QUALITY (guṇa): quality; depends on substance, does not itself possess quality/action

3 ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (karma): motion/action in a substance

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CATEGORY (padārtha): whatever is nameable and knowable
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ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- 3 ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (karma): motion/action in a substance
- 4 SĀMĀNYA: real universal, one-in-many
- 5 VIŚEṢA: ultimate particularity individuating eternal atoms and selves

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- 6 INHERENCE (samavāya): eternal inherence; whole-parts, universal-particular, quality-substance
- 7 ABSENCE (abhāva): absence — prior, posterior, mutual, absolute
- CAUTION: inherence (samavāya) is not conjunction (samyoga), which is separable.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NYĀYA 16 = topics of inquiry, proof and debate means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) | prameya | saṃśaya | prayojana | dṛṣṭānta | established conclusion (siddhānta) avayava | hypothetical reasoning (tarka) | nirṇaya | vāda | jalpa | vitanḍa hetvābhāsa | chala | jāti | nigrahasthāna.

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03

STAGE 03 FOUR MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀṆAS) AND PERCEPTION

FOUR MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀṆAS) AND PERCEPTION

MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀṆAS)

PERCEPTION (PRATYAKṢA)

SENSE-OBJECT CONTACT

SAVIKALPAKA RECOGNITION

INFERENCE (ANUMĀNA)

SIGN (LIṄGA/HETU) THROUGH INVARIABLE CONCOMITANCE (VYĀPTI) TO PROPERTY TO

COMPARISON (UPAMĀNA)

MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇas)

perception (pratyakṣa): sense-object contact → nirvikalpaka → savikalpaka recognition

inference (anumāna): sign (liṅga/hetu) through invariable concomitance (vyāpti) to property to be proved (sādhya)

comparison (upamāna): knowledge through similarity and prior description

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

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- comparison (upamāna): knowledge through similarity and prior description

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- verbal testimony (śabda): trustworthy utterance, ultimately āpta testimony
- PERCEPTION TYPES: external/internal
- ordinary/alaukika alaukika: sāmānyalakṣaṇa, jñānalakṣaṇa, yogaja
- ERROR is mislocation of a real qualifier: misplacement theory of error (anyathākhyāti).

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- verbal testimony (śabda) sentence: ākāṅkṣā + yogyatā + sannidhi/āsatti +
- tātparyā absence: locus (anuyogin) qualified by absent counterpositive (pratiyogin)
- Nyāya knows absence through perception/inference, not separate non-cognition (anupalabdhi)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nyāya knows absence through perception/inference, not separate non-cognition (anupalabdhi).

04

STAGE 04 INFERENCE ENGINE

INFERENCE ENGINE

INFERENCE FOR ONESELF

DEMONSTRATED TO ANOTHER FIVE MEMBERS

1 PRATIJÑĀ

HILL HAS FIRE

2 REASON (HETU)

BECAUSE IT HAS SMOKE

3 UDĀHARAṆA

SVĀRTHĀNUMĀNA: inference for oneself

PARĀRTHĀNUMĀNA: demonstrated to another five members

1 pratijñā: hill has fire

2 reason (hetu): because it has smoke

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SVĀRTHĀNUMĀNA: inference for oneself
- PARĀRTHĀNUMĀNA: demonstrated to another five members
- 1 pratijñā: hill has fire
- 2 reason (hetu): because it has smoke

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- 3 udāharaṇa: wherever smoke, fire — as kitchen
- 4 upanaya: hill has such smoke
- 5 nigamana: therefore hill has fire pakṣadharmatā + invariable concomitance (vyāpti) + uncontradicted application → conclusion
- HETVĀBHĀSA: savyabhicāra, viruddha, satpratipakṣa, asiddha, bādhitā.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- purpose: svārtha
- parārtha direction: pūrvavat
- sāmānyatodṛṣṭa concomitance: kevalānvayi

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: therefore hill has fire pakṣadharmatā + invariable concomitance (vyāpti) + uncontradicted application → conclusion.

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05

STAGE 05 CAUSATION AND ATOMISM

CAUSATION AND ATOMISM

NON-EXISTENCE OF THE EFFECT BEFORE PRODUCTION (ASATKĀRYAVĀDA)

NEW PRODUCTION (ĀRAMBHAVĀDA)

EFFECT IS A NEW BEGINNING, NOT PRE-EXISTENT AS EFFECT

SAMAVĀYI (INHERENT)

ASAMAVĀYI (NON-INHERENT)

NIMITTA (EFFICIENT) EARTH/WATER/FIRE/AIR 2 ATOMS (PARAMĀṆU)

IMPERCEPTIBLE DYAD; 3 DYADS

NON-EXISTENCE OF THE EFFECT BEFORE PRODUCTION (asatkāryavāda) / NEW PRODUCTION (ārambhavāda)

effect is a new beginning, not pre-existent as effect causes: samavāyi (inherent)

asamavāyi (non-inherent)

nimitta (efficient) earth/water/fire/air 2 atoms (paramāṇu) → imperceptible dyad

3 dyads → perceptible triad → gross composite pralaya: composites dissolve

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- NON-EXISTENCE OF THE EFFECT BEFORE PRODUCTION (asatkāryavāda) / NEW PRODUCTION (ārambhavāda)
- effect is a new beginning, not pre-existent as effect causes: samavāyi (inherent)
- asamavāyi (non-inherent)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- nimitta (efficient) earth/water/fire/air 2 atoms (paramāṇu) → imperceptible dyad
- 3 dyads → perceptible triad → gross composite pralaya: composites dissolve
- eternal atoms, selves, space, time remain sṛṣṭi: Lord (īśvara) activates atoms according to unseen causal force (adrṣṭa)/action and

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- TRAP: God orders atoms; God is not the material cause and atoms are not created ex nihilo.
- cause = unconditional + invariable antecedent (ananyathāsiddha) exclude remote, accidental, co-effect and redundant antecedents (anyathāsiddha)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God orders atoms; God is not the material cause and atoms are not created ex nihilo.

06

STAGE 06 SELF, GOD AND LIBERATION

SELF, GOD AND LIBERATION

ENDURING SELF (ĀTMAN)

ETERNAL, MANY, ALL-PERVASIVE SUBSTRATE OF COGNITION, DESIRE AND VOLITION

SENSORY MIND (MANAS)

ATOMIC INNER SENSE LINKING SELF TO ONE COGNITION AT

LORD (ĪŚVARA)

ETERNAL OMNISCIENT EFFICIENT CAUSE; AUTHOR/TEACHER OF VEDA

COORDINATES ATOMS AND KARMIC DESERTS WITHOUT ABOLISHING INDIVIDUAL AGENCY

ENDURING SELF (ātman): eternal, many, all-pervasive substrate of cognition, desire and volition

SENSORY MIND (manas): atomic inner sense linking self to one cognition at a time

LORD (īśvara): eternal omniscient efficient cause; author/teacher of Veda

coordinates atoms and karmic deserts without abolishing individual agency true knowledge → doṣa removed →

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ENDURING SELF (ātman): eternal, many, all-pervasive substrate of cognition, desire and volition
- SENSORY MIND (manas): atomic inner sense linking self to one cognition at a time
- LORD (īśvara): eternal omniscient efficient cause; author/teacher of Veda

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- coordinates atoms and karmic deserts without abolishing individual agency true knowledge → doṣa removed → pravṛtti ceases →
- classical Nyāya does not define it as
- six self-marks: desire

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- Kaṇāda does not foreground creator God unambiguously; later synthesis is explicit

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Kaṇāda does not foreground creator God unambiguously; later synthesis is explicit.

07

STAGE 07 PROOF, OBJECTION AND COMPARISON

PROOF, OBJECTION AND COMPARISON

UDAYANA ROUTES

KĀRYĀT (EFFECT)

ĀYOJANĀT (COMBINATION)

DHṚTYĀDEḤ (SUPPORT) PADĀT (WORD-USE)

PRATYAYATAḤ (TRUST)

ŚRUTEḤ (VEDA)

VĀKYĀT (SENTENCES) SAMKHYĀVIŚEŚĀT (NUMBER)

(prakṛti) material cause

BUDDHISM: momentary process

NYĀYA: new effect from atoms

NYĀYA: enduring substances and selves.

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- UDAYANA ROUTES: kāryāt (effect)

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- padāt (word-use)

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- BUDDHISM: momentary process

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ENDURING SELF (ātman): eternal, many, all-pervasive substrate of cognition, desire and volition
- SENSORY MIND (manas): atomic inner sense linking self to one cognition at a time
- LORD (īśvara): eternal omniscient efficient cause; author/teacher of Veda

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Kaṇāda does not foreground creator God unambiguously; later synthesis is explicit.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- coordinates atoms and karmic deserts without abolishing individual agency true knowledge → doṣa removed → pravṛtti ceases →
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IMPLICATION / VERDICT

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STAGE 07

PROOF, OBJECTION AND COMPARISON

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UDAYANA ROUTES

KĀRYĀT (EFFECT)

ĀYOJANĀT (COMBINATION)

DHṚTYĀDEḤ (SUPPORT) PADĀT (WORD-USE)

PRATYAYATAḤ (TRUST)

ŚRUTEḤ (VEDA)

VĀKYĀT (SENTENCES) SĀMKHYĀVĪŚEṢĀT (NUMBER)

(prakṛti) material cause

BUDDHISM: momentary process

NYĀYA: new effect from atoms

NYĀYA: enduring substances and selves.

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- UDAYANA ROUTES: kāryāt (effect)
- āyojanāt (combination)
- dhṛtyādeḥ (support) padāt (word-use)
- pratyayataḥ (trust)
- śruteḥ (Veda)

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- adr̥ṣṭāt (moral order)
- OBJECTION: atoms + action and moral consequence (karma) may make God redundant; bodies expose unequal suffering
- REPLY: unconscious atoms/unseen causal force (adr̥ṣṭa) cannot intelligently initiate and allocate order
- SĀMKHYA: pre-existence of the effect in the cause (satkāryavāda), primordial material nature
- (prakṛti) material cause

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- BUDDHISM: momentary process
- NYĀYA: enduring substances and selves.
- YOGA LORD (īśvara): special conscious witness (puruṣa) + meditative support
- NYĀYA LORD (īśvara): inferred arranger, efficient cause and karmic governor same name != same proof or systematic function

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NYĀYA LORD (īśvara): inferred arranger, efficient cause and karmic governor same name != same proof or systematic function.

08

STAGE 08

PYQ ANSWER SPINE

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DEFINE TWO-SYSTEM SYNTHESIS

DISTINGUISH NYĀYA 16 INQUIRY TOPICS FROM VAIŚEṢIKA 7 ONTOLOGICAL

FOUR MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀṆAS)

PERCEPTION STAGES

FIVE-MEMBER INFERENCE

MISPLACEMENT THEORY OF ERROR (ANYATHĀKHYĀTĪ)

SELF/SENSORY MIND (MANAS)

DEFINE two-system synthesis → distinguish Nyāya 16 inquiry topics from Vaiśeṣika 7 ontological categories

four means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) → perception stages → five-member inference

misplacement theory of error (anyathākhyāti) → self/sensory mind (manas) → Lord

(īśvara) proofs and objection

new production (ārambhavāda) + three causes → atomistic creation cycle

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEFINE two-system synthesis → distinguish Nyāya 16 inquiry topics from Vaiśeṣika 7 ontological categories
- four means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) → perception stages → five-member inference
- misplacement theory of error (anyathākhyāti) → self/sensory mind (manas) → Lord

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- (īśvara) proofs and objection
- new production (ārambhavāda) + three causes → atomistic creation cycle
- release (apavarga) → compare Sāṃkhya/Buddhism → qualified verdict

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT: the system gains explanatory integration from realism and logical method
- its pressure points are inherence, the leap from order to God, and austere liberation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: the system gains explanatory integration from realism and logical method;.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE

LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE ALL LAYER 3 MATERIAL FROM THE LEGACY

IT SHOULD REFINE A CORE ANSWER, NOT DISPLACE THE

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED ADVANCED UNITY AND HISTORICAL QUALIFICATION

AND VAISESIKA BEGIN AS DISTINGUISHABLE SCHOOLS RATHER THAN ONE

NAVYA-NYAYA THEN SHARPENS THE SHARED ANALYTIC VOCABULARY.

THIS SYSTEM IS REALIST IN THREE LINKED SENSES.

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Layer-placement note
- Layer-placement note All Layer 3 material from the legacy complete session is retained here after practice.
- It should refine a core answer, not displace the printed syllabus.
- LAYER 3 - ADVANCED Advanced unity and historical qualification Historically, Nyaya

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- and Vaisesika begin as distinguishable schools rather than one undifferentiated doctrine.
- Navya-Nyaya then sharpens the shared analytic vocabulary.
- This system is realist in three linked senses.
- Objects exist independently of cognition

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- valid cognition can disclose them
- and even error is explained through misrelation among real factors rather than by reducing the world to appearance.
- The main philosophical cost is ontological commitment.
- To preserve common-sense distinctions, the system admits universals, inherence, ultimate particularizers and absence as real categories.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.